

circumnavigated the globe. Waddell then surrendered his ship to British authorities.

After the war, the U.S. government assessed the damage to its maritime commerce. Confederate raiders had taken 257 merchant ships and whalers, about five percent of the nation's merchant marine. Though the raiders did not wreak the havoc that Stephen Mallory had hoped for, they had driven insurance rates sky high and forced many vessels to adopt foreign registry. Nor did their activity draw many Union ships away from blockading the Southern waterways. At any one time, only a few score Union warships out of the hundreds on blockade duty were hunting for the raiders—barely a dozen—that embarked on the high seas.



Boarding ax

Boarders used this multipurpose ax to help them climb onto enemy vessels when dueling ships lay alongside each other. It was also a handy weapon and a tool for clearing decks of torn rigging and broken timbers.